Executive Summary

Account Plan: 2025 Confluent

Confluent

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Updated By
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Team Members

		Roles	Last Access	Date Added
DP	Duy Pham	Roles: Account Executive	Last Access: 6 months ago	Date Added: February 24, 2025
MW	Michael Wilson	Roles: Solution Architect	Last Access: N/A	Date Added: February 24, 2025

Scorecard

Overall Score: 95.2%

Customer View	Account I...	Ecosystem Strategy	Key Stakeholder...	Technical Landscape (Tech ...	Customer Succe...
100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	67%

Customer View 100%

1.	Account(s) ACV+ Ambition (3-years)	$250K over 3YRS - this is completely greenfield at the moment
2.	Account(s) ACV+ Goal (current fiscal year)	$50K-$100K - break in and understand their OS/Automation/hybrid cloud/AI posture Goal remains the same, as our account team has not been able to penetrate strategic discovery of opportunities yet. Steady CCSP utilizations only.
3.	Account(s) Growth in % (3-years)	50%-100% YoY
4.	Account(s) Growth in % (current fiscal year)	100% if we can close anything this CY since they have zero spend CY24 CCSP: $145K Current CY25 CCSP: $143K - tracking to be greater than last year.

5. Why Red Hat? & Account Growth Plan

Confluent's 2026 IT and modernization strategy builds upon its transformation into an AI-ready data streaming leader, with a focus on global ecosystem expansion, operational modernization, and AI infrastructure enablement. Red Hat's open hybrid cloud technologies—Ansible Automation, RHEL AI, OpenShift AI, and OpenShift Virtualization—can significantly strengthen these initiatives by streamlining automation, accelerating AI development, and enabling infrastructure independence.

<u>Confluent 2026 IT and Modernization Initiatives</u>
Confluent has publicly outlined several modernization and investment programs extending through 2026 :

$200M–$300M global partner ecosystem investment through 2026 to scale integrations with cloud service providers (AWS, Azure, GCP), independent software vendors (ISVs), and managed service providers (MSPs). These funds develop joint go-to-market frameworks, embedded data streaming solutions, and cooperative AI partnerships.

AI-ready data streaming platform initiative, enabling real-time model training pipelines by integrating data observability, governance, and transformation layers that prepare streaming data for AI-driven inference and analytics.

Complete modernization of internal and partner billing systems using modular microservices and centralized rate-card logic to improve agility and visibility, cutting engineering involvement in pricing updates by up to 75%.

Expansion of data streaming modernization programs that help enterprises decouple legacy middleware and refactor message bus architectures using Confluent's Data in Motion platform.

OEM program for embedding Confluent's streaming technology into partner SaaS and analytics products worldwide, supported by new system integration investments (Onibex and Psyncopate).

Infrastructure modernization for scalability and reliability across clouds, emphasizing elasticity, unified observability, and faster deployment using event-driven automation to support new data workloads.

Mapping Red Hat Solutions to Confluent's Modernization Goals

Red Hat technologies map directly into Confluent's 2026 roadmap by providing automation, AI development support, and platform modernization capabilities across hybrid and multi-cloud infrastructures.

Adopting Red Hat technologies within Confluent's modernization framework yields measurable benefits:

- Accelerated AI lifecycle management: With RHEL AI and OpenShift AI, Confluent teams can streamline model development, integrate predictive streaming analytics, and operationalize model retraining directly on real-time data flows.
- Automated deployment and scaling: Ansible Automation enforces consistency across Confluent clusters, enabling seamless scaling and infrastructure-as-code automation.
- Cloud and virtualization freedom: OpenShift Virtualization offers a path away from VMware-based infrastructure, improving cost efficiency and integration flexibility within multi-cloud deployments.
- Improved partner and OEM deployment velocity: Using OpenShift across hybrid environments allows Confluent's partners to rapidly build, certify, and ship embedded streaming solutions.

By combining Red Hat's automation, AI, and hybrid cloud platforms with Confluent's data-in-motion architecture, Confluent can sustain its 2026 goals of powering AI-driven enterprise data streaming, accelerating partner integrations, and achieving greater architectural agility across global cloud ecosystems.

6. Account Plan Risks & Obstacles

Challenges and Risk Assessment

1. Decelerating Growth Rates

Confluent has observed moderating revenue growth rates in recent quarters[2]. This challenge may affect investor confidence and valuation multiples. The potential consequences include difficulty in justifying premium valuation and attracting investment. IT initiatives are focused on product innovation and expansion of use cases to drive growth[2].

2. Intensifying Competition

Increasing competition from tech giants and innovative startups poses a significant challenge[2]. This could lead to potential erosion of market share and pricing pressure, resulting in reduced profit margins and slower revenue growth. Confluent's IT initiatives aim to differentiate through advanced features and integrations[2].

3. Customer Spending Optimization

Cloud-native customers optimizing spending has led to conservative guidance[3]. This creates uncertainty in predicting and planning future revenue streams, potentially challenging Confluent's ability to meet growth targets and maintain investor confidence. IT initiatives focus on developing tools to help customers optimize usage and demonstrate value[3].

External Factors Analysis

Economic Factors:

- Global economic uncertainties may impact enterprise IT spending.
- Increasing interest rates could affect Confluent's valuation and access to capital.

Technological Factors:

- Rapid advancements in AI and ML are driving demand for real-time data processing capabilities.
- Edge computing trends are creating new opportunities and challenges for data streaming platforms.

Regulatory Factors:

- Data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA) are influencing how companies manage and process data streams.

- Industry-specific regulations in sectors like finance and healthcare are shaping data management practices.

7.	What is the level of maturity of this customer with Red Hat?	1. Initial / Ad-Hoc	1
8.	For your customer's entitlements, are they on track to adopt all quantities?	I don't know	1

Account Intelligence (Account Executive) 100%

1. Executive Summary: Customer objectives & challenges & environment

Confluent, Inc. is a leading provider of data streaming platforms, offering solutions built on Apache Kafka. The company has experienced significant growth, with a 25% year-over-year increase in revenue as of Q3 2024[1]. Confluent's primary offerings, Confluent Cloud and Confluent Platform, cater to enterprises seeking real-time data processing capabilities. The company operates in a competitive market dominated by cloud giants but differentiates itself through specialized data streaming expertise and a cloud-agnostic approach.

Confluent, Inc. is a technology company that designs and develops data platforms to help organizations harness business value from stream data[3]. Founded in 2014 by former LinkedIn engineers, Confluent has quickly established itself as a key player in the data streaming market[5].

Key Facts:

- Headquarters: Mountain View, California, USA
- Founded: 2014
- Revenue: $250.2 million (Q3 2024)[1]
- Customers: Approximately 5,680 as of September 30, 2024[6]
- Global Presence: Operations in the US, UK, UAE, and Spain[3]

Business Model Analysis

Revenue Generation

Confluent generates revenue through three primary streams:

1. **Subscription-Based Licensing:** Enterprises pay for access to premium features, support, and maintenance.
2. **Cloud Services:** Usage fees for cloud-based services hosted on popular cloud providers.
3. **Professional Services:** Consulting and training services for implementation and optimization[5].

Value Proposition

Confluent's core value proposition centers on:

- **Real-Time Data Processing:** Enabling businesses to process and react to data in real-time.

- **Streamlined Integration:** Simplifying the integration of data sources and applications.
- **Scalability:** Providing infrastructure to handle large volumes of data.
- **Event-Driven Architecture:** Facilitating the building of responsive business operations[5].

Key Partnerships

Confluent has expanded its partnership with Google Cloud, being named Google Cloud Technology Partner of the Year for the fourth time[6]. This partnership involves:

- Technical integrations with Google Cloud's data and analytics services
- Enhanced go-to-market resourcing
- Collaboration on initiatives like Google Cloud Private Service Connect and the Google Data Cloud Alliance[6]

Business Objectives Analysis

1. Achieve Self-Sufficiency and Profitability
Confluent aims to reach breakeven non-GAAP operating margin in FY24 and improve to 5.3% in FY25[2]. This objective demonstrates financial viability and sustainable growth, critical for investor confidence and long-term stability. Supporting initiatives include cost optimization, revenue growth, and operational efficiency improvements, leveraging cloud services for scalable, cost-effective operations[2].

2. Expand Market Share in Data Streaming

Confluent seeks to capitalize on the growing data streaming market, estimated to reach $100 billion by 2025[4]. This objective solidifies Confluent's position as a market leader in data streaming solutions. Supporting initiatives include product innovation, partnership expansion, and customer acquisition, with IT support focused on developing new features and integrations to enhance platform capabilities[4].

3. Drive AI Integration and Innovation

Enhancing data streaming capabilities for AI applications and real-time processing is a key objective for Confluent[2]. This positions the company as a critical enabler for AI-driven enterprises. Supporting initiatives include partnerships with AI companies and product development for AI use cases, with IT efforts centered on building AI-specific features and optimizations into Confluent's platform[2].

Environmental Factors Analysis

Market Trends and Dynamics

The data streaming market is experiencing rapid growth, driven by increasing demand for real-time analytics, IoT proliferation, and AI/ML integration[4]. Confluent is well-positioned to capitalize on these trends, with its cloud-native offerings and focus on real-time data processing[1].

Competitive Landscape

Confluent faces competition from cloud giants like Amazon (AWS Kinesis), Microsoft (Azure Event Hubs), and Google (Pub/Sub)[5]. However, Confluent differentiates itself through specialized expertise in data streaming and a cloud-agnostic approach[5].

Economic Conditions

Global economic uncertainties, characterized by high inflation and rising interest rates, may impact enterprise IT spending[2]. A survey indicated that 63% of IT leaders anticipate budget cuts in 2024, which could affect Confluent's revenue growth[2].

Technological Advancements

The rapid advancement of AI and ML technologies is driving demand for real-time data processing capabilities[6]. Edge computing trends are also creating new opportunities and challenges for data streaming platforms[6].

2. Customer Business Objectives, Challenges & Key Initiatives

Business Objectives Analysis

Confluent's top business objectives for the next 12-24 months include:

Achieve Self-Sufficiency and Profitability

- Description: Reach breakeven non-GAAP operating margin in FY24 and improve to 5.3% in FY25[2].
- Strategic Importance: Demonstrates financial viability and sustainable growth.
- Supporting Initiatives: Cost optimization, revenue growth, and operational efficiency improvements.
- IT Support: Leveraging cloud services for scalable, cost-effective operations.
- Potential Impact: Improved investor confidence and long-term stability.

Expand Market Share in Data Streaming

- Description: Capitalize on the growing data streaming market, estimated to reach $100 billion by 2025[2].
- Strategic Importance: Solidify position as a market leader in data streaming solutions.
- Supporting Initiatives: Product innovation, partnership expansion, and customer acquisition.
- IT Support: Developing new features and integrations to enhance platform capabilities.
- Potential Impact: Increased revenue and market dominance.

Drive AI Integration and Innovation

- Description: Enhance data streaming capabilities for AI applications and real-time processing[3].
- Strategic Importance: Position Confluent as a key enabler for AI-driven enterprises.
- Supporting Initiatives: Partnerships with AI companies, product development for AI use cases.
- IT Support: Building AI-specific features and optimizations into Confluent's platform.
- Potential Impact: New revenue streams and increased platform adoption.

IT Initiatives and Funding

Data Streaming for AI Initiative

- Purpose: Simplify and accelerate the development of real-time AI applications[3].
- Addressing: AI integration objective and market expansion.
- Funding: Likely significant investment from operating budget and potential R&D allocation.
- Decision Process: Driven by executive leadership with input from product and engineering teams.

Confluent AI Assistant Development

- Purpose: Provide contextual answers and code suggestions for Confluent platform users[3].
- Addressing: Enhancing user experience and driving platform adoption.
- Funding: Internal development resources and potential AI technology partnerships.
- Decision Process: Product management prioritization based on customer feedback and market trends.

Multi-Cloud Strategy Enhancement

- Purpose: Strengthen partnerships with major cloud providers for AI-focused integrations[3].
- Addressing: Market expansion and AI integration objectives.
- Funding: Co-investment with cloud partners and internal resource allocation.
- Decision Process: Strategic partnerships team working with product and engineering leadership.

Resource Allocation and Personnel

- Current Situation: Confluent is likely experiencing high demand for skilled data streaming and AI professionals.
- Skill Gaps: Potential shortage of AI and machine learning experts to drive new initiatives.
- Resource Constraints: Balancing R&D investment with profitability goals may limit hiring.
- Acquisition Strategy: Partnerships with AI companies and cloud providers to access specialized skills[3].
- Impact: Resource constraints could slow down innovation and time-to-market for new features.

3. Customer's Market & Competition

Competitive Landscape

Confluent operates in the competitive data streaming and event processing market. While it faces competition from cloud giants offering similar services, Confluent differentiates itself through its specialized focus and cloud-agnostic approach.

Key Competitors:

- Amazon Web Services (AWS Kinesis)
- Microsoft Azure (Event Hubs)
- Google Cloud (Pub/Sub)
- Apache Kafka (open-source alternative)

Competitive Advantages:

1. **Specialized Expertise:** Deep focus on data streaming and Kafka-based solutions.
2. **Cloud-Agnostic Platform:** Ability to operate across multiple cloud environments.
3. **Full Kafka Ecosystem:** Offering a complete suite of tools around Kafka.

Industry Trends and Market Dynamics

The data streaming market is experiencing rapid growth, driven by:

1. **Increasing Demand for Real-Time Analytics:** Businesses across industries are seeking to leverage real-time data for decision-making.
2. **Growth of IoT and Edge Computing:** The proliferation of connected devices is generating massive amounts of streaming data.
3. **AI and Machine Learning Integration:** Real-time data streams are becoming crucial for AI/ML model training and inference.

Market projections indicate continued growth, with the global data streaming market expected to reach significant valuations in the coming years.

4. How would you categorize the customer's overall approach to adopting digital innovations?

3. Early Majority

1

Ecosystem Strategy 100%

1.	Executive Summary: Ecosystem Strategy	TBC
2.	Which cloud providers is the customer currently working with?	☑ AWS AWS Lambda is mentioned as one of the launch partners for the Connect with Confluent program ☑ Google Cloud Confluent was named a 2024 Google Cloud Partner of the Year award winner1. They collaborate closely on various initiatives, including integrations with BigQuery, Cloud Storage, Cloud SQL, and Dataflow ☑ Other cloud providers (e.g. regional CCSP partners, please list their names) Alibaba Cloud: Listed as one of the launch partners for Confluent's OEM Program
3.	Does the customer have a Committed Spend agreement?	☑ I don't know
4.	What is the customer's level of cloud adoption?	✓ 2. Adopt/Developing 1
5.	Which Consultants, System Integrators, or (Managed) Service Providers/Outsources are currently active within this account that could influence the success of your account plan or strategy?	☑ System Integrators ☑ Managed Services Providers/Outsources
6.	Who are the key incumbent ISV Partners?	TBD
7.	Who are the key hardware & OEM partners of the customer?	☑ Others (please state their names) As for OEM and hardware partners, Confluent has launched an OEM Program targeting managed service providers (MSPs), cloud service providers (CSPs), and independent software vendors (ISVs).

Notes:
Mindgate Solutions: A software developer leveraging Confluent for real-time payment transactions.

Infosys: Mentioned as a launch partner for the OEM Program.

HiveMQ, Imply, Materialize, MongoDB, Onehouse, Precisely, Qlik, Quix, Rockset, Startree, Tinybird, and Waterstream: These companies are listed as launch partners for the Connect with Confluent program.

Additionally, Confluent has invested in two regional systems integrators:

Onibex & Psyncopate

These partners provide data integration and system migration services around the Confluent data streaming platform.

Key Stakeholders Engagement (in collaboration with Marketing Team) 100%

1.	Executive Summary: Key Stakeholders Engagement & Marketing Strategy	As of Feb 2025 - this is a whitespace/greenfield account that needs breaking into via prospecting. So far, one IT Thought-leader identified: Danny Nguyen (Sr. IT Manager) *5Yrs with company*
2.	What is our current level of relationships with the key stakeholders of the customer?	✓ 1. Limited 1

3. Relationship & Marketing Strategy	Once we have connected with a few local resources - we can consider them for localized events and partner outings Whitespace account until then

Technical Landscape (Tech Sales)	100%

1. Executive Summary: Technical Landscape & Competition

Core Platform: Confluent provides a real-time data streaming platform built on Apache Kafka, enabling continuous access, processing, and management of data streams. Its cloud-agnostic architecture supports hybrid and multi-cloud deployments, with fully managed services like Confluent Cloud ensuring scalability and reliability

Key Technical Differentiators

- Real-Time Processing: Enables seamless transfer of live data between systems, critical for AI/ML workflows, operational analytics, and event-driven architectures
- Scalability & Reliability: Handles large-scale data streams with enterprise-grade uptime, ideal for industries like finance and e-commerce
- Open-Source Foundation: Leverages Apache Kafka's ecosystem for compatibility, fostering developer collaboration and rapid innovation
- Cloud Partnerships: Integrates with major cloud providers (AWS, Azure, GCP), offering flexible deployment models and cost optimization

Growth Drivers

- AI/ML Integration: Positioned to capitalize on increasing demand for real-time data pipelines to train models and automate decision-making
- Data Products: Focuses on creating reusable, trusted datasets (data products) to streamline analytics and compliance workflows[7].
- Hybrid Cloud Adoption: Aligns with enterprise trends toward cloud-native solutions, offering tools for seamless migration and management

Partner Considerations

- Interoperability: Confluent's open architecture (e.g., Kafka APIs) allows integration with Red Hat's middleware (e.g., OpenShift) for hybrid cloud orchestration.
- HPC Synergies: Confluent's role in cluster management (e.g., Lenovo EveryScale) highlights potential collaboration in high-performance computing and AI infrastructure
- Security & Compliance: Built-in features for data governance align with Red Hat's focus on

enterprise-grade security and regulatory standards

Recommendations for Engagement

- Highlight joint solutions for real-time AI/ML pipelines and hybrid cloud data mobility.
- Explore co-innovation in Kubernetes-native streaming (e.g., Kafka on OpenShift).
- Leverage Confluent's data product framework to enhance Red Hat's data service offerings.

2.	Server and Cloud Operating System TDP	Confluent's Enterprise OS Landscape
		
		Confluent Platform officially supports RHEL, CentOS, Debian, Ubuntu, AlmaLinux, Rocky Linux, Oracle Linux, and Amazon Linux for production deployments
		
		• Kubernetes Environments:
		  ◦ Worker Nodes: OS must match supported Linux kernel versions (e.g., RHEL 9 uses kernel 5.14, RHEL 8 uses 4.18)
		  ◦ OpenShift: Explicitly supported but requires handling Red Hat's Security Context Constraints (SCC)
		• ARM64 Support: Available from Confluent Platform 7.6.0+ for both on-premises and Kubernetes[18].
		• Windows: Not supported natively; Docker is recommended for non-production use[4].
		• Deployment Tools:
		  ◦ Confluent for Kubernetes (CFK): Requires OS/kernel alignment (e.g., AWS Linux 2023 uses kernel 6.1)
		  ◦ OS Provisioning: Lenovo's HPC documentation references Confluent's OS deployment mechanisms for RHEL/CentOS, including TPM 2.0 encryption for boot volumes[6].
		
		Internal Use: While Confluent's internal infrastructure specifics aren't publicly documented, their technical guidance emphasizes uniform OS versions across clusters and alignment with supported kernels for Kubernetes. Production best practices likely prioritize RHEL or Debian-based systems given their enterprise-grade support and security integration capabilities.

3.	Server and Cloud Operating System Maturity	2. Basic Adoption / Developing 1

4.	Virtualization TDP	Confluent's Virtualization Approach Confluent primarily utilizes Kubernetes-based virtualization for platform deployment and management, with specific integrations for enterprise infrastructure: 1. Kubernetes-Centric Architecture: • Confluent for Kubernetes (CFK): Deploys Kafka, Flink, and related components as containerized workloads on any CNCF-compliant Kubernetes distribution (e.g., OpenShift, Tanzu) • Multi-Cloud Flexibility: Supports Kubernetes clusters on AWS EKS, Azure AKS, and GCP GKE, as well as self-managed distributions like Rancher 1. VMware Integration: • vSphere with Kubernetes: Validated for deploying Confluent Platform via Tanzu Kubernetes Grid (TKG), leveraging VMware's policy-based resource management and micro-segmentation • VM-Based Node Provisioning: Kubernetes worker nodes run as VMs on VMware ESXi hosts, managed through vSphere's native tools (e.g., vMotion, DRS) 1. Hybrid Cloud Virtualization: • WarpStream Orbit: Enables "Bring Your Own Cloud" (BYOC) deployments, abstracting infrastructure dependencies for streamlined migrations • Cross-Cluster Replication: Virtualizes data streams across on-premises VMs and cloud Kubernetes clusters Strategic Emphasis: Confluent prioritizes declarative, API-driven virtualization (e.g., Helm charts, CRDs) over traditional hypervisor-centric models, aligning with cloud-native DevOps practices VMware remains a key partner for enterprises requiring VM-based security and compliance
5.	Virtualization TDP Maturity	2. Basic Adoption / Developing 1

6. Container Management TDP

Confluent's Container Technology Strategy
Confluent employs a Kubernetes-first approach for container orchestration, supplemented by Docker for local development and testing. Key components include:

- Kubernetes-Centric Deployment:
  - Confluent for Kubernetes (CFK): The primary tool for deploying and managing Confluent Platform components as containerized workloads via custom resource definitions (CRDs)4811.
  - Multi-Cloud Support: Integrates with AWS EKS, Azure AKS, GCP GKE, and OpenShift, using Helm charts for declarative configuration
- Docker Integration:
  - Docker Compose: Provides cp-all-in-one Docker Compose files for local development, including Confluent Platform components like Kafka, Schema Registry, and ksqlDB9.
  - DockerHub Images: Maintains official images (e.g., confluentinc/cp-kafka) for rapid deployment of individual components
- GitOps and CI/CD:
  - Declarative APIs: CFK enables GitOps workflows by treating Kafka clusters, topics, and connectors as Kubernetes resources
  - Custom Registries: Supports private Docker registries for enterprise deployments, allowing organizations to host Confluent images internally
- Security and Scalability:
  - TLS and RBAC: Enforces TLS encryption and role-based access control (RBAC) for containerized Confluent Platform components
  - Stateful Workloads: Manages persistent storage for Kafka brokers and other stateful services via Kubernetes storage classes (e.g., AWS EBS, Portworx)

		Confluent prioritizes cloud-native tooling (e.g., CFK Blueprints) over traditional VM-based virtualization, aligning with Kubernetes-native DevOps practices.
7.	Container Management Maturity	2. Basic Adoption / Developing 1

8. Application Platform TDP

Confluent enables event-driven modernization through Apache Kafka, offering:

- Legacy System Integration: 120+ connectors (e.g., IBM MQ, RabbitMQ) to bridge monolithic apps with real-time streams
- Event Sourcing: Replaces direct database access, allowing apps to consume data streams (e.g., billing systems, fraud detection)
- Hybrid Data Plane: Cluster Linking (preview) synchronizes on-premises and cloud Kafka clusters, enabling phased migrations

Pipelines & Supply Chain:

- GitOps-Driven Deployment: Confluent for Kubernetes (CFK) manages Kafka clusters via declarative YAML/CRDs, integrated with CI/CD tools like ArgoCD[^internal].
- Schema Governance: Schema Registry enforces data contracts across teams, ensuring backward compatibility during app updates
- Tiered Storage: Separates hot/cold data storage to optimize pipeline costs for high-throughput workloads

Cloud-Native Architecture:

- Serverless Kafka: Confluent Cloud Freight clusters auto-scale based on demand, with usage-based pricing
- Stateless Microservices: Apps consume Kafka streams via cloud-native SDKs, decoupled from infrastructure (e.g., AWS Lambda, GCP Cloud Run)7.
- Multi-Tenant Isolation: Confluent Cloud enforces performance quotas and access controls to prevent "noisy neighbor" issues

Strategic Alignment:
Confluent prioritizes Kubernetes-native tooling (e.g., CFK Blueprints) and partnerships with platforms like Red Hat OpenShift for hybrid deployments. This approach supports both lift-and-shift migrations (via Replicator) and greenfield event-driven apps.
Key Takeaways:

- Legacy Modernization: Kafka acts as a buffer between legacy systems and cloud-native apps, enabling incremental refactoring

- Unified Data Fabric: Cluster Linking and Tiered Storage create a global event backbone for multi-cloud architectures
- Developer-Centric: Managed connectors and serverless ksqlDB reduce time-to-market for streaming apps

9.	Application Platform Maturity	2. Basic Adoption / Developing	1

10. Mission Critical Automation TDP

Confluent prioritizes Kubernetes-native automation (CFK) for cloud deployments while retaining Ansible/Terraform for legacy systems, ensuring seamless integration with enterprise IT ecosystems like Red Hat OpenShift and VMware Tanzu.

- Confluent for Kubernetes (CFK)
    - Purpose: Deploy/manage Apache Kafka, Flink, and connectors as Kubernetes-native workloads.
- Key Features:
        - Declarative APIs: YAML/CRDs for cluster configurations, topics, and ACLs.
        - Self-Healing: Automatic pod restarts and partition reassignment during failures.
    - Multi-Cloud Support: AWS EKS, Azure AKS, GCP GKE, and Red Hat OpenShift.
- GitOps Integration:
        - ArgoCD/GitHub Actions: Syncs CFK manifests with Git repositories for audit trails.
    - Helm Charts: Preconfigured templates for Confluent Platform components.
- Terraform
    - Use Case: Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) for Confluent Cloud resources (clusters, topics, API keys).
    - Partner Integrations: Works with Snowflake, Databricks, and AWS Glue for end-to-end pipeline automation.
- Ansible
    - Target Environments: On-premises/VMs (non-Kubernetes).
- Playbooks:
        - Zero-Downtime Upgrades: Automates Kafka version migrations.
    - Security Hardening: Enforces TLS encryption and ACL policies.

11. Mission Critical Automation Maturity | 2. Basic Adoption / Developing | 1

12. Red Hat AI TDP

Confluent positions itself as the real-time data foundation for AI/ML, focusing on enabling live data processing and event-driven architectures critical for modern AI workloads.

Core AI/ML Use Case Enablement

- Real-Time Feature Engineering:
  - Kafka Streams/Flink: Process streaming data (e.g., IoT sensor data, clickstreams) to generate features for models (e.g., fraud detection, recommendation engines).
  - ksqlDB: SQL-like queries to transform raw data into ML-ready features (e.g., rolling averages, sessionization).
- Model Training Acceleration:
  - Continuous Data Pipelines: Feed live data to platforms like Databricks MLflow or SageMaker via managed connectors.
  - Data Product Frameworks: Create reusable datasets (e.g., customer behavior streams) for multi-model training.

Streaming AI Integration

- Vector Databases:
  - Kafka Connect Integrations: Sync with Pinecone, Weaviate, or Milvus for real-time embedding updates (e.g., RAG architectures).
- Inference Pipelines:
  - Onnx/Flink ML: Deploy lightweight ML models within Flink jobs for instant predictions on streaming data.
  - Model Serving: Push predictions to Kafka topics for downstream apps (e.g., dynamic pricing engines).

Strategic Partnerships

- Databricks Collaboration:
  - Delta Lake Sink Connector: Stream data directly into Delta Lake for AI/ML training with ACID guarantees.

        - Unity Catalog Integration: Lineage tracking for AI training datasets sourced from Kafka.
    - AWS/Azure/GCP AI Services:
        - Bedrock, Vertex AI, Azure ML: Confluent Cloud's Fully Managed Connectors automate data transfers to cloud-native AI tools.

Vision & Roadmap

- Autonomous Data Pipelines:
    - AI-Driven Optimization: Flink jobs that auto-tune parallelism based on workload patterns.
- Generative AI Integration:
    - LLM Observability: Stream LLM prompts/responses (e.g., OpenAI, Claude) to Kafka for compliance/analytics.
    - RAG Architectures: Use Kafka as the real-time context layer for retrieval-augmented generation.

13. Red Hat AI Maturity	1. Initial / Ad-Hoc 1
14. Key customer applications and workloads	Not known, account is recently inherited and whitespace for penetration
15. Hardware & Storage	Not known, account is recently inherited and whitespace for penetration
16. Security & Compliance	Not known, account is recently inherited and whitespace for penetration
17. Other (products or services not covered under TDP or any of the sections above - e.g. specialized telco plays)	Not known, account is recently inherited and whitespace for penetration
Customer Success (Tech Sales)	67%

1.	Executive Summary: Summary of the customer's expected outcomes using RH Technology, risks & mitigation in achieving those & adoption resources engaged to assist	**Strategic Recommendations** Enhance AI/ML Capabilities: Invest in developing AI-specific features and optimizations to capitalize on the growing demand for AI-powered data streaming[1]. • Expand Multi-Cloud Strategy: Strengthen partnerships with major cloud providers while maintaining a cloud-agnostic approach to cater to diverse enterprise needs[6]. • Focus on Industry-Specific Solutions: Develop tailored offerings for high-potential sectors like financial services, healthcare, and manufacturing to drive adoption and differentiation. • Invest in Edge Computing Capabilities: Develop solutions that can effectively process and analyze data at the edge to address emerging IoT use cases. • Emphasize Cost Optimization: Given the focus on profitability, continue to develop tools and services that help customers optimize their data streaming costs and demonstrate clear ROI[1].	
2.	What is the Red Hat's level of engagement in the customer's adoption journey?	Minimal	3
3.	When did the customer approve the plan (name & function of the customer representative & date of approval)	Not approved	0

Approvals			0%
1.	Is this account plan ready for the sign off by the manager? To be completed by Account Executive.	Yes	
2.	Do you approve this account plan? To be completed by the Sales Manager.	Approved: Solid Quality	0

Whitespace Map

Sales

Mission Critical Automation

- Unset
- ✦ $200K (1)

IT Operations

Red Hat AI

- Unset
- ✦ $100K (1)

Initiatives

2	$350K	$300K	$0	$0
Initiatives	Target	Total	Won	Lost

Name	Target	Total	Won	Lost
Expand Multi-Cloud Strategy - OpenShift	$250K 80%	$200K	$0	$0

↳ Potentials

- Mission Critical Automation
- Sales
- Mission Critical Automation
- $200K

Opportunities
No records

Name	Target	Total	Won	Lost
Drive AI Integration and Innovation	$100K 100%	$100K	$0	$0

↳ Potentials

- Red Hat AI
- IT Operations
- Red Hat AI
- $100K

Opportunities
No records

Stakeholder List

	Name	Role	Relationship	Decision Influence	Support Status
0	Antik K Senior Information Security Engineer	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Anuj Sawani Dir of Product Management - Clou...	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Chad Verbowski Chief Technology Officer	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Danny Nguyen IT Manager	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Elliot Bancroft Cloud Infrastructure Engineer	Champion	Brief Contact	Low	Champion
0	Erik Javier Senior IT Support Engineer III	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Manu Narayan Vice President Of Information Tech...	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Michael Kehoe Cloud Architect	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Nanci Cook-Walker Head of Procurement	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
15	Rick Pollak Head of Information Technology (Sr...	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Thomas K Sr System Engineer	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown
0	Tushar D Director of Application and Infrastr...	Unknown	No Contact	Unknown	Unknown

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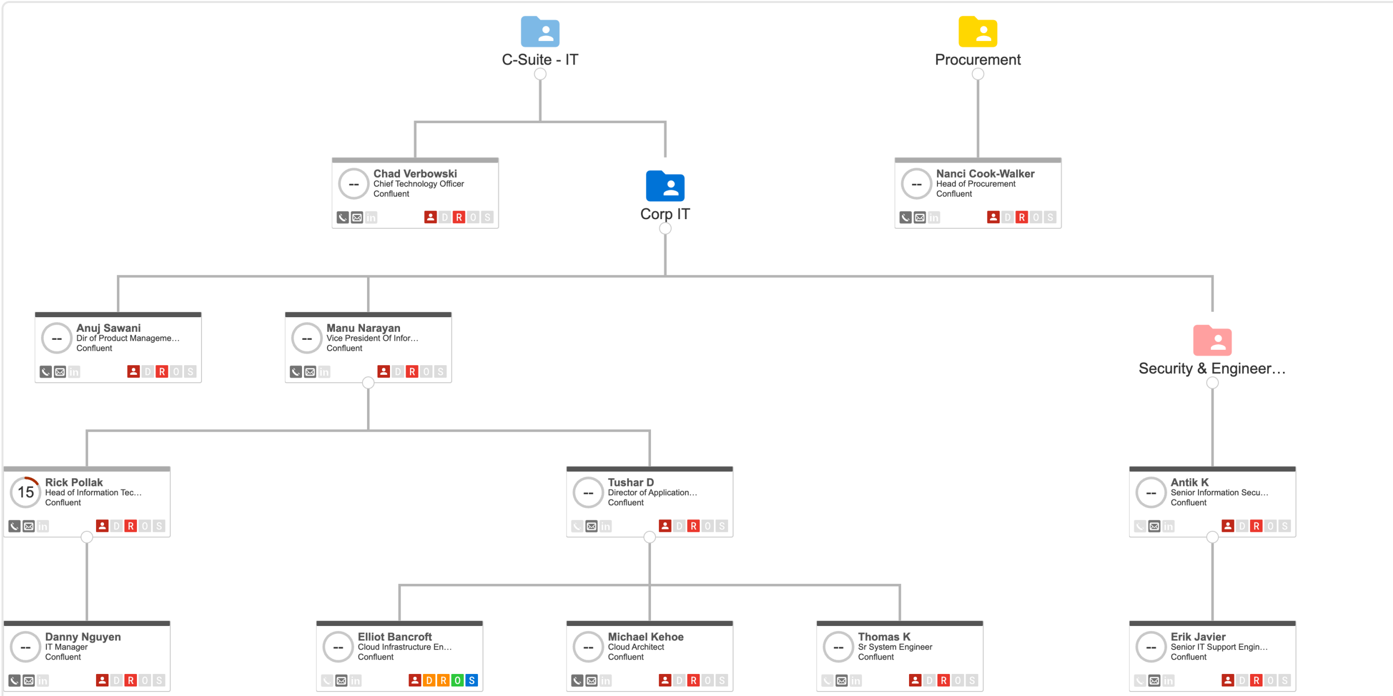
Relationship Map



Key Activities

Subject	Assigned To	Status	Due Date	Type
No records available...				

Legend

Engagement Level

"What is our engagement level over the last 12 weeks"

0-100 score representing the engagement volume & quality over the last 12 weeks.

Engagement Level Score is based on the recency and frequency of matched activity including:

- Emails inbound/outbound
- Meetings completed/scheduled in the future
- External Executive participants in the emails and meetings

Engagement Level Tiers

- 0-49 — **Low**
- 50-74 — **Medium**
- 75-100 — **High**

See this article for more details on the different factors that go into the calculation of Engagement level.

Scorecard

"How much of our Planning methodology has been completed?"

0-100 score representing the completion quality of the overall Scorecard plan.

Scorecard Score is based on the completion of the component sections in the Scorecard plan. Different sections have different weights, as configured by your internal admins.

Scorecard Score Tiers

- 0-54% — **High Risk**
- 55-84% — **Medium Risk**
- 85-100% — **Low Risk**

See this article for more details on Scorecard scoring tiers.

Relationships

Stakeholder Attribute Values

Role
- Budget Owner
- Business User
- Influencer
- Coach
- Procurement
- Other
- Unknown
- Economic Buyer
- Champion

Relationship
- No Contact
- Brief Contact
- Multi-Contacts
- In Depth

Decision Influence
- Very Low
- Low
- Communicates w/ DMs
- High Influence
- Optimal (Executive)
- Unknown

Support Status
- Champion
- Supporter
- Neutral
- Resistor
- Detractor
- Unknown